

Speaker 1 [00:00:06]: Alright, I think we've started now. Before we begin the interview proper, I want to show you a document that is our commitment term. I'll read it quickly for you, mainly because I need your recording authorization again, but I'll show it to you so you can respond to me because it needs to be recorded. Now that we're recording, I'll quickly show it by mirroring the screen. You'll understand too. Let me check here. Can you see it? Well, we are conducting an exploratory study on a multicultural investigation into the conceptualization and measurement of relationship quality, aiming to understand what Brazilian couples consider a good relationship. Further down, if you agree to participate, the interview should last about 40 minutes. It is entirely voluntary. You can stop the interview at any time if you no longer wish to participate. At the bottom, we have the consent for recording the interview audio. Yes, and here below we talk about information sharing. So here we have: I agree with the way the data will be shared, and you can change this option at the end of the interview if you want, depending on the questions you answer. Yes, there are two options here. The first is the complete transcription, excluding sensitive information that you can review after the interview, which can be shared. The second option is that the transcribed excerpts can all be shared, as long as you don't need to be identified. A detail, in both options, you remain anonymous. The information is shared among researchers, but the difference is that the first option excludes the more sensitive parts of the interview, and the second option is the complete transcription. So, can you tell me which option you prefer?

Speaker 2 [00:02:29]: Now complete. It can be complete.

Speaker 1 [00:02:32]: Okay. Great. And just before starting, I'll need your email because I need to send this document to you later, and you need to send it back to me, if possible, marking yes and with your signature here below. Okay? Right after the interview, I'll send you an email with this document. If you could tell me your email now so I can send it.

Speaker 2 [00:02:56]: I can send it in the chat; maybe it's easier.

Speaker 1 [00:02:59]: From Teams. Can you? Yes, you can.

Speaker 2: Where's the chat?

Speaker 1: Oh, at the top, there are a lot of icons. See? The first one is the chat.

Speaker 2 [00:03:17]: Nothing shows up here. I'm not on a computer, just a tablet, so maybe that's why.

Speaker 1 [00:03:25]: I think it appears differently. I can't say how.

Speaker 2 [00:03:28]: But you can, you can tell me, it's easier.

Speaker 1 [00:03:32]: You can tell me. If you want, I can write it here, [redacted].

Speaker 2 [00:03:43]: [redacted].

Speaker 1 [00:03:47]: [redacted].

Speaker 2 [00:03:49]: @gmail.com.

Speaker 1 [00:03:54]: Great. Noted here. Perfect. Okay, I'll stop mirroring the screen now. Let's start the interview properly with some basic questions about you. So, how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:04:14]: [26-30].

Speaker 1 [00:04:15]: [26-30]. How long have you and your partner been together?

Speaker 2 [00:04:21]: Since [Year], [1-5] and a half years.

Speaker 1 [00:04:25]: Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:04:32]: No, no, just a little cat.

Speaker 1 [00:04:38]: Who do you live with?

Speaker 2 [00:04:40]: With her.

Speaker 1 [00:04:41]: Just her? Only her?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: What is your main source of income, and what is your current profession?

Speaker 2 [00:04:49]: I am a [occupation], and my current income is from being a [occupation] under [company] and [company].

Speaker 1 [00:04:58]: Before starting the part of the interview about you two, how would you like me to refer to her, your partner? Girlfriend? Wife?

Speaker 2 [00:05:12]: By her name, [Partner's Name].

Speaker 1 [00:05:15]: [Partner's Name]. Well, can you tell me more or less about your love story? Starting with this question, the more details you can give, the better. Don't worry about the time, the more information you can provide, the better.

Speaker 2 [00:05:35]: So, we worked together. I was her [occupation] in [Year].

Speaker 1 [00:05:42]: And during that time...

Speaker 2 [00:05:44]: [Redacted]. During the time we worked together, we were always very, very close friends, me, her, and her other [occupation] from another shift. The following year, we went to a party together. We went out often, but at this party, we got very drunk and ended up kissing. [11-15] days later, we started dating, and we already had a strong friendship. We were truly different as friends. Until then, I had no romantic thoughts about her. It was just a strong

friendship. By the end of the year, we traveled together, me, her, and her other [occupation], to celebrate the end of the year. We had a moment, nothing physical, just a moment. The following year, we went to this party again, during [Event]. I don't even like [Event], but that's how it was. We kissed again. Everyone was very surprised. I came from a very religious family and never expected this of myself. I didn't expect it. It was a huge shock for me. The next day, we went out again. I was in another universe, didn't know what was happening in my head. We kissed again the next day and for the next [11-15] days, we went out together. For both of us, from our conversations at the time, it was something that was going to end soon. I never thought I would maintain this kind of relationship. But she asked me to date her, assuming it wouldn't last. I accepted, thinking it would end soon.

Speaker 1 [00:08:17]: Really?

Speaker 2 [00:08:18]: But it happened very quickly. Everything happened so fast. But the strong foundation was our friendship. That's why everything happened quickly, because we already knew each other, we already had everything we needed from each other without it being romantic.

Speaker 1 [00:08:37]: And this quick moment you mentioned, was it more about the beginning of getting to know each other romantically, or do you mean everything, even the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:08:47]: Up to dating, it was really fast. It was very fast at the time. I believe it was impulsive decisions, and when I stopped to think, there were confusions in my head. But in the end, that's what I had.

Speaker 1 [00:09:03]: And how would you compare the quality of your relationship to that of your friends'?

Speaker 2 [00:09:13]: Quality, we talk a lot about it. I believe we have a different maturity for several reasons. As a pedagogue, I see it in many aspects. We both have older sisters, which gives us a different sense of responsibility.

Speaker 1 [00:09:35]: Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:09:36]: It helps a lot with differences that could exist but don't, and it even supports the relationship. Having that responsibility, we reached maturity faster because we are older siblings. Even though I have difficulty communicating, expressing, and talking about things that bother me, our strong friendship and previous knowledge of each other make it easier. Today, I have evolved in communication because she is very articulate, and I am not. I am still learning. My difficulty in talking to adults is huge for various reasons. That was a big obstacle, swallowing a lot that could be solved with just a conversation. For her, everything was fine, but I kept quiet, pretending everything was fine.

Speaker 1 [00:10:43]: I understand.

Speaker 2 [00:10:44]: We have a different quality from other relationships. We have a mature way of dealing with discussions. We don't need to argue in front of others. If there's a problem, we keep it calm until we get home. This maturity comes from having had responsibilities all our lives. It creates a different coexistence. Compared to other relationships, especially those of younger people, we notice a difference. Even in the beginning, compared to our past relationships, due to already being friends and knowing each other non-romantically, it eases everything that comes later. We have a different quality in every aspect, even with daily challenges. We maintain a higher level than expected for a good relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:12:14]: I have another question: Do you mind telling me how many romantic partners you've had?

Speaker 2 [00:12:21]: Are we talking about one-night stands or actual relationships?

Speaker 1 [00:12:27]: It's up to you. What do you consider romantic?

Speaker 2 [00:12:36]: I've had romantic moments, something beyond just kissing. It's a complicated question. I've had [1-5] boyfriends, one for a little over [1-5] months and another when I was [11-15] years old, lasting [1-5] months. All were men. She's my first woman. I've had [1-5] other relationships I consider romantic, not just kisses. So, including her, I've had [1-5] that I can recall now.

Speaker 1 [00:13:20]: Hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:13:21]: But they were very short. She's the only long-term one.

Speaker 1 [00:13:25]: You mentioned comparing your relationship's quality to that of your friends. What do you think makes a relationship high or low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:13:46]: I think especially communication, which builds trust. We don't have problems with it. It's one of our strong points. Trust is very rare today, whether people have nothing to hide or a lot. If we try to hide something, we're doing a good job because we don't have insecurities about each other or the past. If I go out alone today, there's no "you can't go." We trust each other. If we're in an open relationship, then it's with me. We don't have that insecurity. Communication is still a challenge for me, but even so, we know it's crucial to talk about what isn't going well. We discuss what was good and what needs to change to avoid stress. Even indirect communication helps. We understand each other's perspectives even when we disagree. These are essential points for a quality relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:15:42]: So you'd say a high-quality relationship requires trust and communication, which are the main words you used? Got it. And for you, what's the most important thing in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:58]: Respect, including something that also involves the quality of the relationship. Respect in all aspects. In general, today's world has normalized disrespect. Even things considered jokes can be deeply disrespectful. I think respect is the key. With respect, you

can have good communication, build trust, even if it takes time due to past issues. Respect leads to trust. Respect is fundamental for everything, not just romantic relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:17:06]: And for you, what is love?

Speaker 1 [00:17:11]: It's a complex question, isn't it?

Speaker 2 [00:17:17]: Very complex. I don't think I can answer it. Love comes in many forms, not just romantic. I can't put it into words. We see love in everything, not just in saying "I love you" but in gestures, actions, and really saying it. It's very complex.

Speaker 1 [00:17:53]: Yes. And how important is love in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:18:00]: I think it's one of the essential things in any relationship. Love grows over time. I'm someone who sees love now, not just in the beginning. Repeat the question so I can formulate it better in my mind.

Speaker 1 [00:18:19]: How important is love in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:18:25]: I think it's in the top three, after respect, because love involves a lot of respect too. So, it's in the top two.

Speaker 1 [00:18:36]: Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:18:37]: It's really essential for any relationship, not just romantic. It involves many things. Love isn't just gestures or respect; it's spending time with that person. Coexistence is crucial because without it, the relationship falls apart. Love is very, very important, along with respect. It's very important to me.

Speaker 1 [00:19:05]: How do you know [Partner's Name] loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:19:16]: We talk about it a lot, and through actions, daily things that show care, respect, and love for each other. It's the little things, like sticking to our routines, even if it's not a requirement, doing things to make the other person happy. Those daily actions show love and make a difference.

Speaker 1 [00:20:27]: Regarding conflict, what are the challenges you face in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:20:34]: Especially my difficulty in communicating.

Speaker 1 [00:20:37]: Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:20:38]: That's our main source of conflicts. [Redacted]. This is our main conflict.

Speaker 1 [00:21:40]: So you would say that you and [Partner's Name] have disagreements, difficulties in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:21:46]: Yes, but I see them as much less than what others experience. We don't share our disagreements with others as much as others do. Our conflicts are less frequent and relevant. Sometimes, what seems trivial to one of us is significant to the other. So, our conflicts are meaningful to our coexistence.

Speaker 1 [00:22:30]: So you think, compared to other relationships, you have fewer conflicts. But how often do they occur in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:22:40]: I see it as rare. Given my difficulty with conflicts, I didn't expect that. We have rare, intense disagreements. There are momentary stresses, but they pass quickly. I don't consider those as conflicts. Our real arguments are rare. We usually try to calm things down before they escalate. The brief stresses are just misunderstandings that pass quickly. I don't count those as conflicts. I focus on the significant ones that affect our coexistence.

Speaker 1 [00:24:08]: Apart from your difficulty expressing yourself, what other reasons cause these disagreements?

Speaker 2 [00:24:21]: Usually, it's about current actions related to past issues we've suffered from. They hit sensitive points. The major conflicts are about these sensitive issues. The medium conflicts are about daily things we've agreed on but sometimes don't follow through with. We prioritize our agreements, but our routines sometimes prevent us from keeping them. These conflicts are minor but annoying. The main conflicts are triggered by past traumas.

Speaker 1 [00:25:55]: You mentioned the importance of dialogue. How do you resolve your disagreements? Do you have any strategies?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: What strategies?

Speaker 2: If we have a strategy, I can't recall now, but we do. We learn certain things to do in certain moments. Sometimes, we pause a discussion to talk later. It's about understanding the moment and deciding the best way to handle the problem now. We discuss whether to address it immediately or wait. It depends on the moment, the day, and our moods. As a pedagogue, I can't define anything specific. It always depends.

Speaker 1 [00:27:26]: Apart from conflict resolution, do you use other methods to maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:27:35]: No, wait, I don't understand.

Speaker 1 [00:27:39]: Maybe this question is similar, but besides conflict resolution, do you have other strategies to maintain your relationship in general? They could be the same or different from conflict strategies.

Speaker 2 [00:28:02]: I see it as trying to talk. Conversation is always our first choice. Sometimes it leads to a fight, but we usually try to talk. We both think and reflect to avoid exaggeration or reduce stress before conflicts. We both do this, especially her, because I'm not good at expressing myself. She tries to understand to avoid bigger conflicts. I can't think of other strategies besides conversation. We value conversation a lot. We're both [occupation] and solve problems daily, so we bring that home.

Speaker 1 [00:29:44]: I see. Would you say your relationship is good for you? Why?

Speaker 2 [00:29:51]: I believe so. It's something I discussed in therapy. I've made progress in personal and professional areas and in our relationship. I've achieved things I didn't know how to before. I've stopped copying behaviors from my parents that I disliked and found alternatives. I've had positive interactions with her family. Being with her gave me moments that are mine, not related to my family. It has positively impacted many aspects of my life and continues to do so.

Speaker 1 [00:32:31]: The next question ties into what you've mentioned, but I'll ask it anyway. Do you believe [Partner's Name] has changed something in you? How? You talked about evolutions, so that's valid. Do you think [Partner's Name] has changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:32:51]: A lot. Many changes were unexpected. I don't like giving romantic advice because everything depends, but one thing I say is that everyone has flaws. You have to see if you can live with them. Some things change, some don't. She has changed in ways I didn't expect. She talks about things she wouldn't before. [Redacted].

Speaker 1 [00:35:42]: I see. Do you feel secure in your relationship? What makes you feel secure or not?

Speaker 2 [00:35:56]: Yes, especially having her support even when I need a reality check. She supports me even when she disagrees because she understands my decisions are mine. This mutual support and communication make me feel secure.

Speaker 1 [00:37:17]: Got it. Before we switch topics, I need a minute because I heard my cats and I think they broke something.

Speaker 2 [00:37:30]: Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:38:30]: I'm back. I don't know if they were fighting or saw another cat outside, but they broke something. Anyway.

Speaker 2 [00:38:41]: How crazy.

Speaker 1 [00:38:42]: Right? Well, I'll quickly share my screen because I need to show you an image for the next questions. This part is also quick. Can you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:39:05]: Yes, I can see it.

Speaker 1 [00:39:07]: This first scale, the phrase "my partner really listens to me." I want you to rate it from 1 (not true) to 9 (completely true). How much do you agree with this statement?

Speaker 2 [00:39:23]: The highest is nine, right? Okay. Seven.

Speaker 1 [00:39:33]: Okay. For the next phrase, the same scale: "my partner cares about my needs." How much do you agree?

Speaker 2 [00:39:45]: I believe this is a nine.

Speaker 1 [00:39:48]: Nine. Can you explain why you chose seven for the first one?

Speaker 2 [00:39:58]: There are moments when, in many of them, I believe it's more my interpretation than reality. But sometimes we want things a specific way, and it's not always necessary. It's not just my opinion that matters. So, I feel that way sometimes.

Speaker 1 [00:41:13]: Can you give a concrete example of this? Something recent or memorable?

Speaker 2 [00:41:20]: It's hard to remember. I can't think of one right now.

Speaker 1 [00:41:33]: Similarly, can you explain why you chose nine for the second statement?

Speaker 2 [00:41:38]: She cares about my needs daily, even things she doesn't agree with. This happened yesterday, for example. We have different cultures, including sitting at the table. My family has a strict rule of eating together, starting and finishing at the same time. Her routine doesn't allow that. Yesterday, even though she doesn't care about this tradition, she waited until I finished eating to leave the table, showing respect for my culture. These little things show she cares.

Speaker 1 [00:44:55]: I understand. Moving to a more sensitive topic, feel free to skip if it's uncomfortable. Have you been sexually active lately?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: How satisfied are you with your sex life, and why?

Speaker 2 [00:45:33]: Comparing it to my past, today I am satisfied. I never felt pleasure with men; it was just routine. With her, I understood that women also deserve satisfaction. It's different and fulfilling.

Speaker 1 [00:46:28]: This part is done. Now, about overall satisfaction. How satisfied are you with your relationship? Can you pick one of these options?

Speaker 2 [00:46:52]: Completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:46:55]: Completely satisfied. Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:46:58]: There are problems, but they are expected difficulties. Overall, completely satisfied.

Speaker 1: Within your response of complete satisfaction, how would you rate your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:47:23]: This isn't about sex, right?

Speaker 1 [00:47:26]: No, it's about everything.

Speaker 2 [00:47:28]: Then completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:47:30]: You'd give it a ten. Can you explain why you chose ten and not a lower score, like five or zero?

Speaker 2 [00:47:46]: The issues we have are normal. They're expected problems between two people with different cultures and upbringings. Overall, we maintain a balance. The fact that we were friends first helps a lot. Our problems don't prevent us from having a ten because they are manageable differences.

Speaker 1 [00:49:11]: I see. We're almost done with the interview. I'd like to summarize some points. You talked about maturity, strong friendship, importance of dialogue, trust, respect, daily actions, and evolutions. Mainly, your difficulty in expressing yourself as a conflict source. Would you like to add anything or discuss something I didn't ask about?

Speaker 2 [00:50:00]: I can't think of anything else. The questions were specific, and I tend to ramble, so we covered a lot. I can't think of anything beyond what was asked.

Speaker 1 [00:50:20]: Great. Thank you for participating, [Participant's Name]. Before we finish, I'd like to ask again if you want to keep your initial choice of complete transcription.

Speaker 2 [00:50:40]: Yes, keep it.

Speaker 1 [00:50:41]: Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:50:42]: One more thing. What's the purpose of this research?

Speaker 1 [00:50:50]: The goal is to understand couples' perceptions of relationship quality. What do you consider a high or low-quality relationship? This research is being conducted in several countries, including the Philippines, Turkey, and the US. We're in the early stages, so there isn't much data yet. But that's the goal. I can share more if you're interested.

Speaker 2 [00:51:20]: Just curious. Very interesting. Good luck with the research.

Speaker 1 [00:51:27]: Thank you. I need to ask two more things. First, can you recommend two people for the study? I'm interviewing LGBT couples, and I need one more LGBT couple and one non-monogamous couple.

Speaker 2 [00:51:55]: Couples in general?

Speaker 1 [00:51:58]: Yes, but with these classifications. I can't interview heterosexual couples. I need an LGBT couple and a non-monogamous one.

Speaker 2 [00:52:11]: I don't know what non-monogamous means.

Speaker 1 [00:52:14]: It means an open relationship, not polygamy. It's non-monogamous.

Speaker 2 [00:52:53]: I know a couple in an open relationship, but we're not close. [Partner's Name] might know them. The LGBT couple I knew isn't together anymore. I'll think about it.

Speaker 1 [00:53:20]: I need someone who can refer a couple, not the couple directly. If you know someone who might know an LGBT or non-monogamous couple, please pass their contact to me.

Speaker 2 [00:53:45]: I'll think about it. I know someone, but I'm not sure if they'll help. I'll ask [Partner's Name] too.

Speaker 1 [00:54:05]: If you can inform them about me and my research and get confirmation, that would be great. Whenever you can.

Speaker 2 [00:54:20]: She's traveling today. I'll ask her when she returns.

Speaker 1 [00:54:25]: That's fine. Another thing, I have an interview with [Partner's Name] now. I need her contact. Can you pass the link through our chat or give me her number?

Speaker 2 [00:54:46]: I don't know if it changes anything for you, but I'll go somewhere else and she'll join.

Speaker 1 [00:54:59]: I need to record them separately. I'll open another meeting and send a new link.

Speaker 2 [00:55:10]: I'll ask her and let you know.

Speaker 1 [00:55:16]: Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:55:54]: You can send the link to her email. She's on her computer now.

Speaker 1 [00:55:59]: Okay, can you give me her email?

Speaker 2 [00:56:00]: Sure.

Speaker 1 [00:56:02]: You can tell me, or write it in [Social Media].

Speaker 2 [00:56:08]: It's easier to tell you. It's not difficult.

Speaker 1 [00:56:13]: Sure, tell me.

Speaker 2 [00:56:20]: [Partner's Name] with an [redacted].

Speaker 2 [00:56:28]: [Partner's Name] [redacted].

Speaker 2 [00:56:36]: As in [redacted].

Speaker 1 [00:56:39]: Got it. Noted.

Speaker 2 [00:56:43]: She's on the computer now. Good luck with your research.

Speaker 1 [00:56:47]: Thank you. Thanks for participating.

Speaker 2 [00:56:51]: Good luck. Bye-bye.

Speaker 1 [00:56:52]: Thank you. Bye.